

Creator Ads Interview Analysis

Validating Aurora's Market Hypotheses Against a Category Leader

Interview with Kevin Ramlow (Go-to-Market Engineer, Creator Ads) • September 11, 2026 • Conducted and analyzed by Kaiane Souza

1. Purpose and Sources

This document consolidates the findings from a research interview conducted with Kevin Ramlow, a Go-to-Market Engineer at Creator Ads, one of the leading technology-driven platforms in the Brazilian creator economy market. The interview aimed to validate Aurora's early market hypotheses against the operating reality of an established player — specifically around pricing predictability, client segmentation, automation maturity, and the role of agencies in the value chain.

Four sources were used to build this analysis: (1) the interview question script prepared in advance, organized into five thematic blocks (market growth, client profile, automation, creator dynamics, and agency role); (2) the full interview transcript; (3) an automatically generated meeting summary; and (4) personal notes taken during the conversation. Where these sources diverged in detail, the transcript was treated as the primary source of record.

2. Market Growth and the ROI Measurement Gap

Creator Ads confirms that only a small share of total media budgets currently flows to creator campaigns, but frames the market as actively transitioning rather than stagnant: internal media investment tracking shows a visible migration of spend toward the creator economy. The primary obstacle reported is not lack of interest but the absence of a clear, comparable ROI framework. Brands accustomed to traditional media evaluate performance at the bottom of the funnel, while influencer campaigns — especially those built on micro and nano creators — are often oriented toward brand positioning and long-term relevance rather than immediate conversion.

To bridge this gap, Creator Ads runs a proof-of-concept model: a smaller, lower-cost first campaign is used to demonstrate measurable return before a client commits to a larger engagement. A second, more proactive mechanism was also described: a social-listening system that detects emerging trends and triggers outbound proposals with a pre-defined scope (e.g., a fixed number of creators at a fixed price), removing the need for the brand to originate the creative idea. These trend-driven campaigns typically run on very short timelines, sometimes launching within days of the opportunity being identified.

3. Client Profile, Minimum Investment, and Self-Service

3.1 Segmentation and investment floor

Creator Ads serves clients of all sizes but actively prioritizes the largest media spenders in the market, using an internal qualification process for inbound demand. A minimum investment threshold exists and is described as necessary for two reasons: it covers the operational cost of running a campaign, and it protects the platform's core thesis — that a sufficiently large pool of micro/nano creators outperforms a single large-follower creator. Below that threshold, the creator pool would be too small to prove the thesis, so

smaller brands that fall under the minimum are generally not served.

3.2 Fully managed service, with a self-service pilot on hold

Every campaign today runs through a dedicated Customer Success Manager; brands do not operate the platform directly. The engagement follows a fixed structure — kickoff, recurring syncs (cadence scaled to campaign size), and a results presentation. A self-service pilot was tested successfully but was deprioritized in favor of core product development. Notably, the direction under consideration for self-service is not human-first but **agent-first**: an MCP-based integration that would let a brand's own AI agents operate the platform directly, a demand that has surfaced specifically from international clients whose marketing teams already launch campaigns through agents on other channels.

4. Real-Time Optimization and Pricing Logic

Creator pricing has moved away from a flat follower-count model toward a multi-factor formula that incorporates engagement history and a penalty score for behaviors such as missed deadlines or non-delivery. Each creator is priced individually, but this granularity is intentionally hidden from the brand, which only sees aggregate cost-per-view and cost-per-engagement figures for the campaign as a whole.

Mid-campaign budget reallocation is a confirmed, actively used lever: when certain content outperforms during a campaign, budget originally set aside for additional creator contracts can instead be redirected into paid boosting of the top-performing content, which is now executed natively inside the platform (direct integrations with Google and Meta ad systems, no third-party ad operations). This reallocation decision, however, remains a human one — made jointly by the internal team and the brand — and was explicitly noted as not yet automated, which stands out as a gap even at the most technologically advanced player in the category.

5. Proprietary Technology Stack

Three products were described as the core of Creator Ads' technical differentiation, all aimed at maximizing the ratio of campaign scale to headcount:

- **SmartMatch** — matches creators to campaign briefs using natural-language inputs from the brand (niche, profile type, campaign goal). It builds a processed profile from each creator's video history to improve match precision, and over-invites relative to the target headcount (e.g., roughly 120–150 invitations for 100 slots), routing extra acceptances into an automatic waitlist. Manual review is reserved for complex or highly niche campaigns.
- **Guardian** — an AI system for brand safety and content review against the campaign brief. It is credited with reducing the review team needed for a 2,000-creator campaign from an estimated 20–50 people to roughly 3–5, escalating to a human only in flagged, ambiguous cases.
- **Whisper** — a creator-facing support agent (built in-house by the interviewee) that handles briefing or date changes and day-to-day creator questions. It resolves 70% of tickets fully autonomously (rising to 86% when abandoned/incomplete tickets are included) across a volume of roughly 1,000–2,000 tickets per day, with a two-person CX team — one coordinator and one person actually handling escalations.

Note. Reported resolution benchmarks (70% and 86%) were shared as internal metrics from the interviewee and were not independently verified against external data.

6. Creator Acquisition and International Expansion

Creator acquisition combines organic signups — driven by brand recognition already established in Brazil — with paid creative acquisition, where campaign-specific ads drive creators to a low-friction web sign-up form rather than requiring an app download upfront. Only social account access and basic profile data are required at this first step; full profile completion can happen later through the web or the app.

The company's Brazilian reputation was cited as a direct asset in its recent expansion into Mexico: a first campaign was closed within roughly a week of entering the market, driven by a direct referral between executives rather than a cold go-to-market motion. This suggests that, for this category, trust and reputation transfer across markets faster than the product itself needs to be localized.

7. Agency Role — Direct Validation of Aurora's Hypothesis A

This is the most strategically significant finding for Aurora. Creator Ads treats agencies explicitly as clients, positioned alongside brands rather than as intermediaries to be disintermediated. Depending on how a given brand's contract with its agency is structured, Creator Ads engages partially or entirely through the agency, passing a portion of the campaign value to it as an intermediary. The interviewee described agencies as “bridges” that help the market grow, rather than as competitors — with one caveat: agencies that scale influencer operations manually, without adopting comparable technology, were named as indirect competitors in specific cases.

This maps closely onto the decision already made in Aurora's persona work (see Table 1 below): **Hypothesis A — Agency as Client**, where the agency uses Aurora's infrastructure to operate campaigns on behalf of its own clients, was chosen over disintermediating the agency (Hypothesis C) or treating it purely as a curation partner (Hypothesis B). The interview provides direct, real-world evidence that the market's most technologically advanced player runs the same playbook at scale, which meaningfully de-risks that earlier decision.

Table 1

Aurora's Agency Hypotheses vs. Creator Ads' Confirmed Practice

Hypothesis	Aurora's framing	Creator Ads evidence
A — Agency as client (<i>adopted</i>)	Agency operates campaigns for its own clients on top of the platform, as infrastructure.	Confirmed as the default model: agencies are billed/treated as clients and receive a share of campaign value as intermediaries.
B — Curation partner	Agency's human judgment on brand-voice fit is paid for as a service layer.	Not the primary structure described; human judgment was not framed as a separately monetized layer.
C — Disintermediated	Product replaces most agency functions; agency becomes a competitor or distribution channel.	Only true for agencies that scale manually without adopting technology; not the general case.

Note. Column 3 synthesizes statements made across the transcript regarding agency relationships (see Section 7). Aurora's three original hypotheses are documented in the persona-building notes (Personas Iniciais).

8. Cross-Check Against Aurora's Initial Personas

Beyond the agency question, several points raised in the interview intersect directly with the pains mapped for Aurora's three personas.

Table 2
Persona Assumptions Compared to Interview Findings

Persona	Assumed pain	What the interview shows
Marina (brand)	Wants predictable, programmatic-style pricing for nano/micro creators.	Even the category leader hides creator-level pricing from the brand and only exposes aggregate CPV/CPE — predictable, simplified pricing at the brand's view remains an open need, not a solved one.
Duda (creator)	Wants fast, transparent, fair payment.	Not directly addressed in this interview; pricing formula and payment terms from the creator's side were not detailed and remain a gap to probe further.
Renata (agency)	Fears disintermediation; wants multi-client/white-label management with protected margin.	Confirmed: agencies operate as intermediated clients, retaining their relationship with the brand and a share of the value. This validates Hypothesis A directly (see Table 1).

Note. Persona pains as originally documented in Personas Iniciais (Marina, Duda, Renata).

9. Implications for Aurora

- **Pricing transparency is a real, unsolved gap.** If the market leader still abstracts creator-level pricing away from the brand, a product that gives brands clearer, more granular cost visibility — without necessarily exposing creator-level detail publicly — is a differentiated angle, not a redundant one.
- **The minimum-investment floor creates an underserved segment.** Brands below Creator Ads' qualification threshold are effectively turned away; this is a concrete opening for a lower-ticket entry point in the mid-market.
- **Mid-campaign reallocation is still manual, even here.** Automating the decision of when to boost versus when to contract additional creators is an unclaimed technical opportunity.
- **Agent-first self-service is early but directionally validated.** The demand is coming specifically from more agent-mature international clients; worth monitoring as a forward-looking feature rather than building for it immediately.
- **Hypothesis A is corroborated and should stay the working model.** No further hypothesis testing is needed on the basic agency-as-client structure; remaining open questions are about the specific multi-client/white-label mechanics Renata would need (see Personas Iniciais, “Próximo passo”).

10. Limitations

This analysis is based on a single interview with one representative of Creator Ads. Figures such as ticket-resolution rates, invitation-overbooking ratios, and review-team headcounts are self-reported and were not cross-checked against external or public data. No proprietary financial or strategic information was

requested, in line with the interview's original scope, so exact fee structures and margin data remain unknown.

References

Exame. (2025). *Media investment in influencer marketing in Brazil* [Data from Kantar Ibope Media and Statista, as cited in interview preparation materials].

Ramlow, K. (2026, September 11). *Creator Ads interview* [Personal interview transcript]. Conducted by K. Souza.